

Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Bladder & Kidney Channels – Week 5

Sections A–F + Inter-Quiz · Interteaching Format

This prep guide follows the behavioral interteaching model: complete it BEFORE lecture, using the Study Guide / Cram Sheet / assigned reading as source material. Bring your answers and your Section E confusion points to class – interteaching pairs/groups are built to target exactly those gaps.

Section Map	
A	Factual Recall <i>terminology, counts, first/last points</i>
B	Conceptual Understanding <i>pathway logic, branches, function</i>
C	Clinical Application <i>trap notes, indications, scenarios</i>
D	Synthesis & Connections <i>posterior circuit, prior weeks</i>
E	Points of Confusion <i>muddiest-point – bring to class</i>
F	Discussion / Pair-Share <i>prompts for your interteaching group</i>
Q	Inter-Quiz <i>ACQ (new BL/KI) + MAINT (retention check, Wk 1–4)</i>

Answer from memory first; check against the Study Guide only after.

Self-score the Inter-Quiz honestly – it's designed to keep Weeks 1–4 active before the midterm-era material.

Section A — Factual Recall

Answer from memory first; check against the Study Guide only after.

1 How many points on the Bladder channel? Kidney channel? What is the combined total?

2 Name the first and last point of BL. Name the first and last point of KI.

3 State the element, polarity, and peak two-hour window for BL and for KI.

4 Name BL's pertaining organ and connecting organ. Name KI's pertaining organ and connecting organ.

5 Which point is the Confluent point of KI, and which extraordinary vessel does it open?

6 List all five categories of Five-Transport (Jing-Well/Ying-Spring/Shu-Stream/Jing-River/He-Sea) points for BL, with point numbers.

Section B – Conceptual Understanding

Explain the logic, not just the list – these map directly to the running-course quiz format.

- 1 Sketch (in words) all 5 branches of the Bladder channel in order. Where do branches 4 and 5 reconverge?

- 2 Explain why the two parallel lines on the back are drawn as running SIMULTANEOUSLY rather than sequentially. What was the specific student question that raised this in lecture, and how did Dr. Zhang answer it?

- 3 Sketch (in words) all 3 branches of the Kidney channel. Which branch connects KI to the channel that opens Week 6?

- 4 Explain the two-rule function framework (running-course function vs. internal-organ function) and apply it to BOTH BL and KI.

Section C – Clinical Application

- 1 A patient presents with heel pain. Per Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical teaching point, which channel should you think of FIRST, and why?

- 2 A patient has urinary retention. Name the channel and explain the internal-organ logic that makes it the first choice.

- 3 Which point corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion, and which point is described as the 'aspirin of acupuncture'?

- 4 A patient reports dry mouth, sore throat, and a diagnostic concern at the root of the tongue. Which channel's pathway explains this, and why?

Section D — Synthesis & Connections

- 1 Dr. Zhang states that, as of this lecture, the Posterior Circuit is complete. Name all four channels that make up the Posterior (Inner) Circuit and the order in which the course covered them.

- 2 Compare BL's Back-Shu series to a channel/point category you've already learned (e.g. LU7/LI4, or the Front-Mu points). What is the shared clinical logic of a 'transport' or 'command' point category?

- 3 KI is the second channel this course has connected to the root of the tongue. Which was the first (Week 3)? What does this suggest about tongue-root diagnosis?

- 4 Both BL and KI are Water-element channels. Restate what 'Water' governs physiologically and how that shows up in each channel's clinical pearls.

Section E — Points of Confusion (Muddiest Point)

Interteaching works because YOUR confusion drives the in-class discussion groups. Be specific — "I don't understand X because Y" is more useful to your pair than "I'm confused about BL." Bring this page to class.

- The single most confusing pathway detail this week:

- The single most confusing point-category / special-points detail this week:

- A clinical application I still can't confidently explain:

- A specific question I want answered in lecture:

Section F — Discussion / Pair-Share Prompts

For use in class with your interteaching pair or small group.

- 1 Compare your Section E confusion points with your partner's. Where do they overlap? Where do they diverge?

- 2 Teach your partner the 5 BL branches from memory, in order, without notes. Have them check you against the Study Guide.

- 3 Quiz each other on the confusable-point pairs (BL60/62/63; KI3 vs KI7; KI6 vs KI7; BL40/54/57). Which pair is hardest for each of you, and why?

- 4 Discuss: if you were writing a Quiz 4 question designed to catch the BL-does-not-connect-to-Lung trap, what would it look like?

Inter-Quiz

ACQ = new BL/KI | MAINT = retention check, Wk 1-4

Self-score honestly before lecture. MAINT items pull from LU/LI/ST/SP/HT/SI (Weeks 1-4) to keep prior channels active in memory ahead of the midterm-era material.

Name the point that is both Yuan-Source AND Shu-Stream on the Kidney channel.

[ACQ]

Name the point that is both Yuan-Source AND Shu-Stream on the Lung channel. (Week 2)

[MAINT]

Which BL point is the He-Sea AND the Command point for the back?

[ACQ]

Which ST point is the Command point for the abdomen? (Week 3)

[MAINT]

What are the two channels BL shares its 14 cross-points with?

[ACQ]

What point opens the Chong Mai, and what channel is it on? (Week 3)

[MAINT]

Which KI point is the Confluent point, and which extraordinary vessel does it open?

[ACQ]

Which SI point is the Confluent point, and which extraordinary vessel does it open? (Week 4)

[MAINT]

State the full Back-Shu series from BL13 to BL28 with their organs, in order.

[ACQ]

Name the Front-Mu point of the Heart and of the Small Intestine. (Week 4)

[MAINT]

Inter-Quiz — Answer Key

Check your Inter-Quiz answers here — no peeking until you've written your own.

- [ACQ]** KI3 (Taixi) — the Kidney channel's Shu-Stream point doubles as its Yuan-Source point, the key tonic point for both Kidney Yin and Yang.
- [MAINT]** LU9 (Taiyuan) — same dual role on the Lung channel: Shu-Stream AND Yuan-Source. This pattern (Yuan-Source = Shu-Stream) holds on all Yin channels, never on Yang channels.
- [ACQ]** BL40 (Weizhong), at the popliteal crease — He-Sea point and Command point for the back. Clears summer-heat; treats low back pain and stiffness of the spine.
- [MAINT]** ST36 (Zusanli) — He-Sea point and Command point for the abdomen. Also the #1 tonic point in TCM (Nature-published anti-inflammatory effects, per Dr. Zhang).
- [ACQ]** The Governor Vessel (GV/Du Mai) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel — BL's 14 cross-points concentrate mostly around the head, shared with these two channels.
- [MAINT]** SP4 (Gongsun), on the Spleen channel — Confluent point opening the Chong Mai (Penetrating Vessel). Paired with PC6 (Neiguan) in the confluent-point system.
- [ACQ]** KI6 (Zhaohai) — Confluent point opening the Yinqiao Mai (Yin Heel Vessel). Treats insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation.
- [MAINT]** SI3 (Houxi) — Confluent point opening the Du Mai (Governing Vessel). Paired with BL62 (Shenmai), which opens the Yang Qiao Mai.
- [ACQ]** BL13 Lung, BL14 Pericardium, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL19 Gallbladder, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL22 San Jiao, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder.
- [MAINT]** Heart: CV14 (Juque). Small Intestine: CV4 (Guanyuan). Both are Ren Mai points on the midline abdomen/chest, distinct from the channels' own Back-Shu points (BL15, BL27).